



Spiders and scorpions

Spiders and scorpions are the best-known members of the arachnid family. They are two of the most feared creatures on Earth, despite the fact that most do not attack humans.

Spiders

There are about 40,000 species of spider in the world. They can all bite, but most are not dangerous to humans.

Of all spiders, jumpers have the best eyesight.



Jumping spider

This is the silk line that the jumping spider attaches to something before it jumps.

The jumping spider spots a fly and leaps, attached to a line of silk,

Scorpions

Scorpions live in warm climates and feed on insects. A scorpion holds its prey with its big pincers and paralyses it with the sting on the end of its tail, which it bends right over its back.

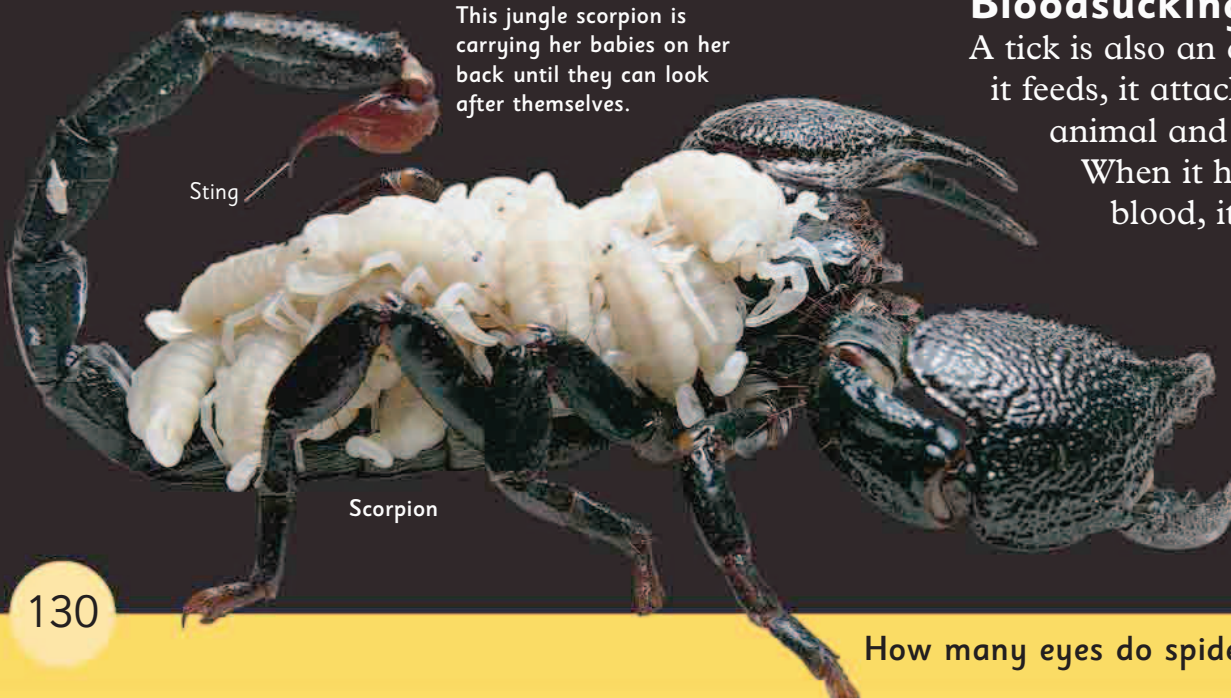
Ticks are so small that you can barely see them.



Bloodsucking ticks

A tick is also an arachnid. When it feeds, it attaches itself to an animal and bites the flesh. When it has drunk enough blood, it drops off.

This jungle scorpion is carrying her babies on her back until they can look after themselves.



Scorpion

Some scorpions grow to lengths of 15 cm (6 in).